

Founder Handbook

A decision reference for building Solar Static Studio

From Idea to Digital Reality.

1. North Star

Solar Static Studio transforms selected ideas into distinctive visual identities and fully realized digital products.

The studio is industry-flexible but project-selective. Visual identity is often the entry point; digital realization is the outcome.

2. Who the Company Is Built For

Prioritize founders, organizations, artists, and creative businesses that have:

- A meaningful idea and a real reason to bring it to market.
- A clear decision-maker and willingness to collaborate.
- A realistic budget for thoughtful, custom work.
- A need for two or more connected capabilities: strategy, identity, website, product, or publication.
- Potential to create a strong result, case study, referral, reusable process, or future product insight.

3. Service Hierarchy

Level	Service	Current Position
Core	Visual Identity	Lead offer. Proven through client work.
Core	Website Design, Development & Deployment	Lead offer. Best combined with identity and launch work.
Selected	Digital Product / iOS MVP Development	Technically proven; accept only clear, controlled scopes until commercially validated.
Supporting	Editorial & Publication Design	Useful as an add-on or when the project genuinely requires it.

4. Evidence Today

Commercially validated

- Brand identity design.
- Website design, development, deployment, and revision management.
- Educational and publication design.
- End-to-end client communication and project delivery.

Technically validated

- Product definition, UI/UX, iOS development, testing, and App Store launch.
- Effective use of AI-assisted development workflows.

Not yet commercially validated

- Paid iOS MVP engagements.
- Stable maintenance retainers.
- Productized services, recurring revenue, and owned commercial products.

5. Project Selection Filter

Before accepting a project, answer each question honestly:

Criterion	Required Question
Alignment	Does the project fit visual identity, digital experience, product execution, or publication design?
Outcome	Can the desired result and definition of completion be stated clearly?
Client	Is there one accountable decision-maker who can provide timely feedback?
Economics	Can the budget support the time, quality, risk, and revision load?
Capacity	Can the studio deliver the work reliably with current skills and available time?
Strategic Value	Will the project create profit, evidence, a strong case study, a referral path, or reusable knowledge?

Decision rule: accept when the objective, client, scope, economics, and delivery capacity are all credible. Clarify unknowns before proposing. Decline when a core condition is structurally weak.

6. Non-Negotiable Operating Rules

- Do not begin work without a signed agreement and deposit.
- Define scope, deliverables, exclusions, timeline, payment schedule, and revision limits in writing.

- Keep feedback in one agreed channel.
- Do not promise enterprise-scale systems, unlimited support, or unvalidated capabilities.
- Do not accept low-price template work that weakens positioning and consumes high-touch time.
- Do not confuse activity with company-building. Every major task should strengthen revenue, proof, systems, or owned assets.

7. Growth Model

1. **Service revenue:** sell high-quality identity and website engagements.
2. **Productized services:** standardize repeated parts of discovery, delivery, and pricing.
3. **Recurring revenue:** add carefully scoped maintenance, support, or ongoing design relationships.
4. **Owned products:** use repeated client problems and internal knowledge to create digital assets that can earn without direct hourly delivery.

8. Capital Discipline

Borrowed startup capital must amplify a validated opportunity, not replace discipline.

- Do not draw HELOC capital simply because it is available.
- Know the rate, carrying cost, repayment plan, and maximum acceptable loss.
- Spend only when the expense clearly creates time, capacity, qualified demand, stronger proof, or an owned asset.
- Validate the core service, website, case study, proposal process, and target pricing before material spending.
- Release capital in stages and stop when the expected evidence does not appear.

9. Founder Decision Check

Before a major decision, ask:

- Does this strengthen the studio's positioning?
- Is it based on evidence or excitement?
- Will it create revenue, proof, a reusable system, or an owned asset?
- What will it cost in cash, time, attention, and reputation?
- What am I explicitly choosing not to do?
- What result would justify continuing, and what result would make me stop?